



FINANCING GUIDE / 10

Startup Financing

A practical guide to capital options for new and recently established businesses that may not yet meet traditional operating-history requirements.

Startup financing is different from conventional cash-flow lending because a new business may have limited or no operating history. Depending on the program, underwriting can rely more heavily on the owner's personal credit profile, personal income, liquidity, experience, business plan, use of funds, and the asset being financed.

A new business isn't automatically ruled out for lacking 12 months of revenue — FLS routes the request toward programs built for newer businesses and evaluates the owner's profile and transaction from there.

Common use cases

- Initial business launch costs
- Early marketing and working capital
- Purchase startup equipment
- Fund select franchise or acquisition-related costs
- Build initial operating capacity before traditional business lending becomes available

HOW LENDERS LOOK AT IT

What typically drives the financing decision

Owner credit profile

Established tradelines, utilization, recent inquiries, derogatory items, bankruptcy history, and overall personal credit depth can be important in unsecured startup programs.

Personal income and liquidity

Some credit-based programs require proof of income or the ability to support obligations while the business is new.

Business plan

Use of funds, projections, owner experience, industry, and a credible path to revenue can matter, especially for larger or more structured requests.

Asset or transaction

Equipment, franchise rights, acquired business assets, or other financeable assets can open additional paths.

PREPARING YOUR REQUEST

What to have ready

Requirements vary by program, but a complete and organized package helps FLS identify the right path and reduces unnecessary back-and-forth.

Owner

Personal credit authorization, income documentation, personal financial information, and identification.

Business

Entity documents, business plan/projections when applicable, use-of-funds budget, and ownership information.

Transaction

Equipment quote, franchise/acquisition documentation, or other invoices/contracts tied to the request.

PROCESS

From request to funding

1 Identify the stage

Identify whether the business is pre-revenue, newly operating, or approaching one year in business.

2 Review the owner

Review owner credit, income, liquidity, experience, and use of funds.

3 Evaluate paths

Evaluate unsecured/credit-based, equipment, acquisition, or other startup-compatible paths.

4 Complete the application

Complete the program-specific application and documentation.

5 Review the structure

Review approved structures carefully — startup products can vary significantly in cost and form.

WHAT CAN STRENGTHEN THE REQUEST?

Strong established personal credit, low utilization, clean recent history, documented income/liquidity, relevant experience, and a specific use of funds can improve startup options.

Find the right startup financing path

FLS Capital Advisors works across multiple financing sources rather than forcing every request into one program. Answer a few questions about your business and financing objective, and a specialist will review the paths that may fit.

flscapitaladvisors.com/start Talk with a specialist: flscapitaladvisors.com/contact

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